homes, which were circular—the bhunga, like my room in the local hotel. However, the city kept shrinking, until it was finally abandoned around 1500 BCE. As with much else about Dholavira in particular and the Harappan Civilization in general, no one is sure why this vital urban centre ended when it did. We do know, however, that Dholavira outlasted other well-known cities like Mohenjo-Daro and Harappa by up to two centuries.

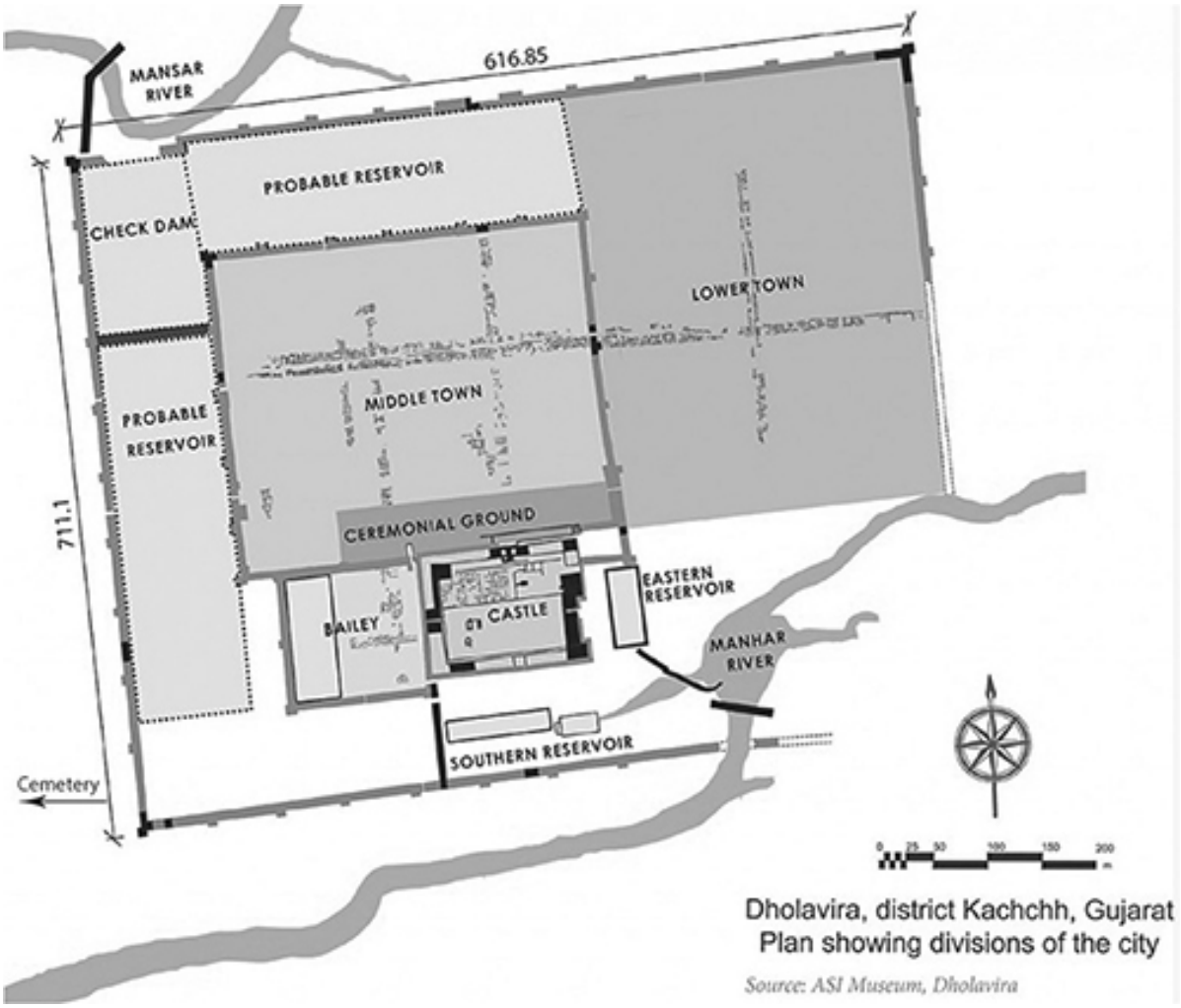


Figure 3. Site plan of Dholavira with major divisions

Three major sections of the city have been identified: ‘citadel’, ‘middle town’ and ‘lower town’, in descending order of prosperity and civic amenities. To the south, on higher ground, is the citadel, where the elites